AN EXCLUSIVE GUIDE



The Other Side of

FOURTEEN

5 TIPS TO LIVING YOUR HARD TRUTH

What fourteen years taught me about losing a life, and finding my own

BY

Leora Johnson

Founder, Live Hard Truth



THE FOUNDER

Leora Johnson

Founder, Live Hard Truth
Fairburn, Georgia

MEET LEORA

Every piece carries a truth she lived first.

Leora Johnson did not build Live Hard Truth from a mood board. She built it from life: the seasons that broke her open, and the truths she found on the other side.

Her most recent hard truth came at the end of a fourteen-year relationship. Fourteen years of shared plans, shared routines and a shared name for the future. When it ended, she had a choice: shrink back into the story everyone expected, or stand fully in who she was becoming.

She chose to stand. Live Hard Truth is what that choice looks like when you can wear it. Every affirmation is a sentence she had to learn to say out loud first, so that you can wear it with your head up.

> *"Your truth is not the thing that breaks you. It is the thing that finally lets you breathe."*
>
> LEORA JOHNSON

A LETTER FROM LEORA

Fourteen years. One ending. A whole new me.

I want to be honest with you, because that is the whole point of this guide.

I spent fourteen years with someone. That is not a chapter, that is a volume. When it ended, I did not just lose a person. I lost the routine of my days, the picture I had of my future, and for a while, the sound of my own voice.

Nobody hands you instructions for that. People tell you to move on, stay busy, get back out there. What nobody tells you is that the way through starts with one uncomfortable, freeing thing: telling the truth. To yourself first, then to the world.

These five tips are the ones that carried me. They are not theory. They are what I practiced, day after day, until I recognized myself again. Each one ends with a journal prompt and an affirmation, so you do not just read your truth. You live it.

If you are on the other side of your own fourteen, whatever your number is, this is for you.

Leora Johnson

INSIDE

4 **Tip 1**
Tell yourself the truth first

5 **Tip 2**
Grieve what was real

6 **Tip 3**
Stop negotiating with what's over

7 **Tip 4**
Find the "I" inside the "we"

8 **Tip 5**
Wear your truth out loud

9 **My Hard Truth**
A 7-day journal practice

10 **The First Collection**
Launching October 15

HARD TRUTH TIP 1 OF 5

Tell Yourself the Truth First

1

You cannot heal a story you are still editing.

MY STORY

For a long time I told a version of the story that made it easier to live with. It was complicated. It was mutual. It was fine. None of that was the whole truth, and as long as I kept softening it, I stayed stuck in it.

Healing started the day I said it plainly, to myself, with nobody to impress: this ended, it hurt, and I am allowed to name exactly why. You do not owe anyone a tidy version. You owe yourself an honest one.

THE HARD TRUTH

Name what happened in plain words. No spin, no blame, no protecting anyone's image, including your own.

JOURNAL PROMPT

Write the story of what ended in five sentences, the way you would tell your closest friend at 2am.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I am strong enough to hear my own truth."

HARD TRUTH TIP 2 OF 5

Grieve What Was Real

2

Fourteen years is not a chapter. It is a life. Let yourself mourn it.

MY STORY

People expected me to bounce back. But fourteen years means birthdays, holidays, inside jokes, a whole shared language. Losing that is a real loss, even when leaving is the right thing.

I learned that grief does not mean you made the wrong choice. It means something mattered. When I stopped fighting the sadness and gave it room, it finally started to move through me instead of sitting on my chest.

THE HARD TRUTH

Grief is not weakness and it is not regret. It is love with nowhere to go, and it needs somewhere to land.

JOURNAL PROMPT

What did I love about that life? Write it down without apologizing for missing it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I can honor what was real and still choose what is next."

HARD TRUTH TIP 3 OF 5

Stop Negotiating With What's Over

Closure is not something they give you. It is something you decide.

3

MY STORY

I spent months replaying conversations, rewriting what I should have said, waiting for an explanation that would finally make it make sense. Every "what if" kept one foot in a door that had already closed.

The shift came when I stopped waiting for closure from someone else and gave it to myself. I set boundaries, some quiet and some firm, and I kept them even when it would have been easier not to.

THE HARD TRUTH

You do not need their agreement to be finished. Your peace is not up for negotiation.

JOURNAL PROMPT

Which "what if" am I ready to release, and what boundary will protect my peace?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

“I close doors that no longer lead to my peace.”

HARD TRUTH TIP 4 OF 5

Find the "I" Inside the "We"

4

Somewhere in fourteen years of "we," there is a woman waiting to hear her own name.

MY STORY

After so long as half of a pair, I had to ask questions I had not asked in years. What music do I actually like? How do I want my Saturdays to feel? What did I put on hold that I still want?

Rediscovering myself did not happen in one big moment. It happened in small, stubborn choices: a new route to work, a class I always wanted to take, a Sunday that belonged only to me. Each one was a small truth, and together they added up to me.

THE HARD TRUTH

You are not starting over. You are starting from experience, and that is a stronger place to begin.

JOURNAL PROMPT

What is one thing I loved before "we" that I want back this month?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I am whole on my own, and I am worth rediscovering."

HARD TRUTH TIP 5 OF 5

Wear Your Truth Out Loud

What you survived can become what you stand for.

5

MY STORY

The day I stopped hiding what I had been through, something changed. Women started telling me their stories back. Their fourteen was twenty, or six, or a job, or a family rift. The details were different. The truth underneath was the same.

That is why Live Hard Truth exists. Not to put pain on display, but to put courage where people can see it. When you wear your truth, you give someone else permission to live theirs.

THE HARD TRUTH

Your story does not disqualify you. It qualifies you to help the next woman through.

JOURNAL PROMPT

If my truth were printed across my chest, what would it say?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I live my hard truth, and it sets me free."

MY HARD TRUTH

A 7-day journal practice

Give yourself one week. One prompt a day, ten quiet minutes, no editing. Write it in the margins here, or in the Live Hard Truth Journal.

DAY 1

The truth I have been avoiding is...

DAY 2

What I miss, and what I do not miss at all...

DAY 3

The "what if" I am ready to release is...

DAY 4

Something I loved before "we" that I want back...

DAY 5

A boundary I will keep, even when it is hard...

DAY 6

What this season is teaching me about my worth...

DAY 7

My hard truth, in one sentence I would wear on my chest...

THE FIRST COLLECTION

Wear the truth you lived.

LAUNCHING

October 15

Every piece comes in multiple colors. Shown here is the Fall Collection, our seasonal edit.

THE JOGGERS SET

Heavyweight hoodie and cargo jogger, LIVE HARD TRUTH pressed tone-on-tone



Espresso



Onyx



Ember



Merlot

THE ESSENTIALS

Each available in multiple colors



The Hard Truth Journal

Embossed cover, built for the prompts in this guide.



The Hard Truth Mug

For the first honest thought of the morning.



The Hard Truth Hat

Embroidered Live HT logo. For days your truth leads.



THE LAST WORD

Your truth was never the end of the story.

It is the beginning of the one you get to write.

LIVE HT HARD TRUTH™

THE FIRST COLLECTION

Joggers sets, journal, mug and hat

Every piece in multiple colors

Launching October 15

This guide shares personal experience and encouragement. It is not a substitute for professional counseling. If you are struggling, reach out to someone you trust or a licensed counselor.

© 2026 Live Hard Truth. All rights reserved.